Mathematical Language

Notation and Conventions

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Contents

About This Document 1

Part I. General Conventions and Writing 1

1 General Conventions 1

2 Mathematical Writing 2

Part II. Notation by Subject 6

3 Set Theory and Logic 6

4 Calculus and Analysis 8

5 Linear Algebra 12

6 Differential Equations 14

7 Numerical Analysis 16

8 Combinatorics and Discrete Mathematics 17

9 Probability and Statistics 18

10 Geometry 20

11 Number Theory 22

12 Algebra 23

13 Topology 25

14 Miscellaneous Notation 27

About This Document

Mathematical Language records the notation and writing conventions adopted here. It is guided by deliberate personal preferences together with established mathematical practice; when no personal convention has been fixed, standard mathematical usage is the default.

This document is non-exhaustive. Alternative notations are listed in preferred order: the first is used by default, while later forms remain acceptable when context or established usage favors them. Unlisted notation is not necessarily invalid.

For unlisted notation, prefer established mathematical usage or introduce clear notation appropriate to the context.

Part I. General Conventions and Writing

1 General Conventions

Prefer parentheses for ordinary grouping when delimiters are interchangeable, including in nested expressions. Use other delimiters when established mathematical notation calls for them.

In LaTeX mathematical source, put one source-space after punctuation commas. TeX determines the typeset spacing; retain explicit spacing commands only where typographically appropriate.

Notation follows adopted preferences and established mathematical usage. Standard symbols may have different meanings in different contexts.

Item	Convention
Scalars	Ordinary mathematical italic letters, for example a, b, c, λ, t.
Vectors and Matrices	Vectors and matrices are written in bold, typically using lowercase and uppercase letters, respectively, such as $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{x}$ and $\mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B}, \mathbf{M}$. Greek symbols are likewise bold when representing vectors or matrices, such as $\boldsymbol{\xi}, \boldsymbol{\Phi}$. Established field-specific conventions are respected. Unless otherwise stated, vectors are column vectors.
Matrix Delimiters	Parentheses are preferred; square brackets are a standard alternative.
Dimension Subscripts	Use dimension subscripts when informative; omit them when the dimension is clear or irrelevant
Number Systems	Blackboard-bold letters, such as $\mathbb{N}, \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$
Fields	Arbitrary fields are typically denoted by italic uppercase letters such as F, K, L. Established blackboard-bold notation, such as $\mathbb{F}$ and $\mathbb{F}_q$, is also used where appropriate.
Sets	Ordinary uppercase letters such as A, B, X, Y, unless a field-specific convention requires otherwise.
Families and Collections	Calligraphic letters, such as $\mathcal{F}$; script letters, such as $\mathscr{A}$, represent distinct notation
Symbol Distinctions	Different mathematical letterforms and alphabets are treated as distinct symbols, even when based on the same letter. For example, ε and ϵ, φ and ϕ, and A, A, $\mathbf{A}$, $\boldsymbol{A}$, $\mathcal{A}$, $\mathscr{A}$, $\mathbb{A}$, $\mathfrak{A}$, A, and $\mathtt{A}$ are distinct symbols.
Named Operators	Upright Roman type, for example det, ker, im, rk, and tr.
Large Operators	Use display-style large operators and conventional index placement; use compact forms only when the layout requires them

Notation	Meaning
$(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$	Ordered tuple
$(a_n),\ \{a_n\}$	Sequence

Notation	Meaning
$(a_i)_{i\in I},\ \{a_i\}_{i\in I}$	Indexed family over I
(a, b)	Open interval
$[a, b]$	Closed interval
$[a, b)$	Left-closed, right-open interval
$(a, b]$	Left-open, right-closed interval
$\{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$	Set delimiters
$\{x \in A \mid P(x)\}$, $\{x \in A\colon P(x)\}$	Set-builder notation
$\langle x, y\rangle$	Pairing or inner product, according to context
$\lvert x\rvert$	Absolute value, modulus, cardinality, or order, according to context
$\lVert x\rVert$	Norm
$a = b$	Equality
$a \coloneqq b$	a is defined to be b.
$a \equiv b$	Identity, equivalence, or congruence, according to context
$a \cong b$	Isomorphism or congruence, according to context
$a \approx b$	Approximation
$f\colon X \to Y$	Function or map from X to Y
$x \mapsto f(x)$	Elementwise rule of a map
$f\colon X \to Y,\ x \mapsto f(x)$	Function with domain, codomain, and mapping rule
$g \circ f$	Composition: first f, then g
$f\lvert_A,\ f \restriction_A$	Restriction of f to A
id_X	Identity map on X

2 Mathematical Writing

Mathematical Environments.

Item	Convention
Definition	Precise meaning of a term, object, property, or construction.
Notation	Introduction or declaration of mathematical notation.
Convention	Standing choice of notation, terminology, normalization, or usage for the stated context.
Axiom	Fundamental statement accepted without proof as part of a mathematical system.
Assumption	Premise adopted for the current statement, argument, construction, or discussion.
Hypothesis	Condition under which a result or theory is considered; traditionally named hypotheses retain their established terminology.
Conjecture	Statement proposed to be true but not proved in full generality.
Theorem	Principal mathematical result.
Proposition	Mathematical result of more limited scope or emphasis.
Lemma	Supporting result, usually used in another proof.
Corollary	Result following readily from a preceding result.
Claim	Local or intermediate assertion within a larger argument.
Fact	Established mathematical statement presented without the emphasis of a named result.
Observation	Mathematical feature or consequence readily recognized from the current context.

Item	Convention
Proof	Rigorous argument establishing a mathematical assertion.
Sketch	Outline of the essential reasoning in a proof, construction, or solution, with some details omitted.
Formula	Distinguished mathematical identity or closed-form expression.
Algorithm	Explicit step-by-step procedure for carrying out a mathematical or computational task.
Construction	Specification of how a mathematical object is defined or built to meet stated requirements.
Design	Explanation of component roles and the rationale behind structural choices in a mathematical object, function, method, or environment.
Example	Concrete instance illustrating a definition, concept, method, or result.
Counterexample	Example disproving an assertion or showing that a condition is necessary.
Application	Use of a mathematical concept, method, or result in a specific mathematical or applied setting.
Recall	Reminder of previously introduced or assumed-known mathematical material relevant to the current discussion.
Motivation	Explanation of why a concept, method, problem, or development is introduced or worth considering.
Intuition	Informal insight suggesting what to expect or why a mathematical statement or method seems plausible, without constituting a proof.
Remark	Supplementary mathematical clarification, qualification, or extension of the surrounding material.
Note	Brief contextual or practical information, such as a usage instruction or permission.
Comment	Retrospective interpretation or takeaway concerning the preceding material.
Warning	Important notice of a subtlety, common error, or potentially misleading point.
Question	Question raised for thought, exploration, or discussion without necessarily requiring a complete solution.
Problem	Mathematical task intended to be solved.
Exercise	Task primarily intended to practice, apply, or reinforce mathematical material.
Open Problem	Problem not known to be solved in its stated form.
Hint	Partial clue intended to guide the reader toward a proof or solution without giving the complete argument or answer.
Suggestion	Optional recommendation to consider a particular observation, method, or approach.
Idea	Key insight guiding a proof, solution, or construction.
Strategy	Broad plan for approaching a problem, proof, or construction.
Tactic	Local step within a larger strategy.
Solution	Resolution of a stated problem or task by proof, computation, construction, or other appropriate means.

Proof, sketch, and solution labels are written as *Proof*, *Sketch*, and *Solution*, respectively, each followed by a period.

Notation	Meaning
□	Ending for ordinary proofs and solutions

Notation	Meaning
■	Ending for substantial, difficult, or particularly important proofs
Q.E.D.	Ending for exceptionally difficult, significant, or paper-level proofs

Enumeration and Subdivision. Enumeration labels are set in upright Roman type. Their form is determined by structural role rather than nesting depth.

Item	Convention
1.1, 1.2, 1.3, ...	Independent child problems or standalone units under a common parent; each is a distinct subproblem that may be stated, solved, and referenced separately.
(1), (2), (3), ...	Ordinary parallel enumeration, such as choices, cases, possibilities, alternatives, examples, or procedural steps; not a subdivision of a single problem or a clause of a formal mathematical statement.
(a), (b), (c), ...	Connected subparts of a single problem or task that share a common statement, setup, or context.
(i), (ii), (iii), ...	Formal mathematical clauses within definitions, theorems, propositions, lemmas, and related statements, such as hypotheses, conditions, properties, conclusions, or equivalent statements.

Nesting does not change the structural roles of these labels.

Mathematical Shorthand.

Typeset Abbreviations may be used in mathematical documents, textbooks, problem sets, and solutions, as well as in handwritten work, when appropriate to the context and level of formality. Handwritten Shorthand is reserved for personal notes, scratch work, and blackboard writing.

Typeset Abbreviations.

Notation	Meaning
i.e.	that is
e.g.	for example
etc.	and so on
cf.	compare
resp.	respectively
vs.	versus
i.o.w.	in other words
s.t.	such that
iff	if and only if
w.r.t.	with respect to
const	constant
a.e.	almost everywhere
a.s.	almost surely
i.i.d.	independent and identically distributed
N.t.	Note that
w.l.o.g.	without loss of generality
w.t.s.	want to show (that)
e.t.s.	enough to show (that)
t.f.a.e.	the following are equivalent
i.t.s.w.	in the same way

Notation	Meaning
o.t.o.h.	on the other hand
LHS	Left-hand side
RHS	Right-hand side
IVT	Intermediate Value Theorem
EVT	Extreme Value Theorem
MVT	Mean Value Theorem
FTC	Fundamental Theorem of Calculus
ODE	Ordinary Differential Equation
PDE	Partial Differential Equation
IVP	Initial Value Problem
BVP	Boundary Value Problem

Handwritten Shorthand.

Notation	Meaning
Def	Definition
Thm	Theorem
Prop	Proposition
Lem	Lemma
Cor	Corollary
Pf	Proof
Sol	Solution
Ex	Example
Exer	Exercise
Rmk	Remark
Sps	Suppose (that)
cont	continuous
cont.ly	continuously
difb	differentiable
difb.ly	differentiably
difl	differential
bdd	bounded
unif	uniform
unif.ly	uniformly
lin	linear
lin.ly	linearly
dep	dependent
indep	independent
approx	approximate
triv	trivial
fnc	function
seq	sequence
eqn	equation
eqlt	equality
ineqlt	inequality
sys	system
comb	combination

Notation	Meaning
vec	vector
mat	matrix
col	column
pt	point
bdy	boundary
nbhd	neighborhood
itvl	interval
op	operation
num	number
val	value
elmt	element
cw	clockwise
ccw	counterclockwise
w/	with
w/o	without

Mathematical Phrases.

Phrase	Use
We find by inspection that ...	Used when a conclusion follows directly from inspection.

Part II. Notation by Subject

3 Set Theory and Logic

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\},\ \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1},\ \mathbb{Z}^+$	Positive integers
$\mathbb{N}_0 = \{0, 1, 2, 3, \dots\},\ \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$	Nonnegative integers
$\mathbb{Z}$	Integers
$\mathbb{Q}$	Rational numbers
$\mathbb{R}$	Real numbers
$\mathbb{C}$	Complex numbers
$\varnothing,\ \emptyset$	Empty set
$x \in A$	x is an element of A.
$x \notin A$	x is not an element of A.
$A \subseteq B$	A is a subset of B; equality is allowed.
$A \subsetneq B$	A is a proper subset of B.
$A \supseteq B$	A is a superset of B; equality is allowed.
$A \supsetneq B$	A is a proper superset of B.
$A \cup B$	Union
$A \cap B$	Intersection
$(A_i)_{i \in I}$	Indexed family of sets
$\bigcup_{i \in I} A_i$	Union of an indexed family of sets
$\bigcap_{i \in I} A_i$	Intersection of an indexed family of sets

Notation	Meaning
$\limsup_{n\to\infty} A_n$	Set-theoretic limit superior of (A_n)
$\liminf_{n\to\infty} A_n$	Set-theoretic limit inferior of (A_n)
$A \setminus B,\ A - B$	Set difference
$A \triangle B,\ A \,\Delta\, B$	Symmetric difference
A^c	Complement of A in the ambient set
$\mathcal{P}(A),\ 2^A$	Power set
$A \times B$	Cartesian product
$A_1 \times \cdots \times A_n,\ A^n$	Finite Cartesian product; A^n is the n-fold Cartesian power of A
$\prod_{i\in I} A_i$	Cartesian product of an indexed family of sets
$A \sqcup B,\ A \,\dot\cup\, B$	Disjoint union
$\bigsqcup_{i\in I} A_i$	Disjoint union of an indexed family of sets
$A \cap B = \varnothing$	A and B are disjoint.
$R \subseteq X \times Y$	Binary relation between X and Y
xRy	x is related to y by the relation R.
R^{-1}	Inverse relation of R
$[x]_R,\ [x]$	Equivalence class of x under R
$x \sim y$	Equivalent elements under an understood equivalence relation
$A/\!\sim$	Set of equivalence classes
$\operatorname{dom} f$	Domain of f
$\operatorname{codom} f$	Codomain of f
$f(A)$	Image of A under f
$f^{-1}(B)$	Preimage of B under f
$\operatorname{im} f$	Image of the map f
Y^X	Set of all functions from X to Y
$f^{-1}\colon Y \to X$	Inverse function of a bijection $f\colon X \to Y$
$f\colon X \hookrightarrow Y$	Injective map
$f\colon X \twoheadrightarrow Y$	Surjective map
$f\colon X \hookrightarrow\!\!\!\!\twoheadrightarrow Y$	Bijective map
$f\colon X \xrightarrow{\sim} Y$	Isomorphism; for sets, equivalently a bijection
$\mathbb{1}_A(x)$	Indicator function of A
$\forall x \in A$	For every $x \in A$
$\exists x \in A$	There exists $x \in A$.
$\exists! x \in A$	There exists a unique $x \in A$.
$\nexists x \in A$	There does not exist $x \in A$.
$P \Rightarrow Q$	P implies Q in ordinary mathematical writing.
$P \Leftarrow Q$	Q implies P in ordinary mathematical writing.
$P \not\Rightarrow Q$	P does not imply Q.
$P \Leftrightarrow Q$	P if and only if Q in ordinary mathematical writing.
$P \wedge Q$	Logical conjunction
$P \vee Q$	Logical disjunction
$\neg P$	Logical negation
$\top,\ \bot$	Truth and falsehood constants, respectively, in formal logic
$\varphi \to \psi,\ \varphi \leftrightarrow \psi$	Conditional and biconditional connectives in formal logic
$\mathcal{M} \models \varphi,\ \mathcal{M} \not\models \varphi$	$\mathcal{M}$ satisfies, or does not satisfy, the formula φ.
$\Gamma \models \varphi,\ \Gamma \not\models \varphi$	φ is, or is not, a semantic consequence of Γ.

Notation	Meaning
$\Gamma \vdash \varphi,\ \Gamma \nvdash \varphi$	φ is, or is not, syntactically derivable from Γ.
$\lightning$	Contradiction reached in a proof or argument; distinct from the formal falsehood constant $\bot$
$\therefore$	Therefore
$\because$	Because
$\lvert A\rvert,\ \#A$	Cardinality
$\aleph_0$	Cardinality of a countably infinite set
$\mathfrak{c}$	Cardinality of the continuum

4 Calculus and Analysis

The differential d is upright; ε is the default small positive quantity in analysis.

Notation	Meaning
$\lim_{x\to a} f(x),\ f(a^{\pm})$	Two-sided limit at a
$\lim_{x\to a^-} f(x),\ f(a^-)$	Left-hand limit at a
$\lim_{x\to a^+} f(x),\ f(a^+)$	Right-hand limit at a
$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x),\ f(\infty)$	Limit as $x \to \infty$
$\lim_{x\to-\infty} f(x),\ f(-\infty)$	Limit as $x \to -\infty$
$\lim_{x\to a} f(x) = \pm\infty$	Infinite limit at a
$\min A$	Minimum of A
$\max A$	Maximum of A
$\inf A$	Infimum of A
$\sup A$	Supremum of A
$\arg\min_{x\in A} f(x)$	Set of minimizers of f over A
$\arg\max_{x\in A} f(x)$	Set of maximizers of f over A
$\overline{\mathbb{R}} = \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty, +\infty\}$	Extended real line
$f'(a)$	First derivative of f at a
$f^{(n)}(a)$	nth derivative of f at a
$\dfrac{\mathrm{d}y}{\mathrm{d}x}$	Derivative of y with respect to x
$\dfrac{\mathrm{d}^n y}{\mathrm{d}x^n}$	nth derivative of y with respect to x in Leibniz notation
$\dfrac{\partial f}{\partial x_i},\ \partial_i f,\ f_{x_i}$	Partial derivative with respect to x_i
$\dfrac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_j \partial x_i},\ \partial_{ji} f,\ f_{x_i x_j}$	Mixed partial derivative, first with respect to x_i and then x_j
$D_{\mathbf{v}} f(\mathbf{a}),\ \partial_{\mathbf{v}} f(\mathbf{a})$	Directional derivative of f at $\mathbf{a}$ along $\mathbf{v}$
$\mathrm{d}f = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \dfrac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}\,\mathrm{d}x_i$	Total differential of a scalar function of n variables
$\int f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$	Indefinite integral of f
$\int_a^b f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$	Definite integral over $[a, b]$
$\int_a^\infty f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x,\ \int_{-\infty}^b f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$	Improper integrals over unbounded intervals
$\int_a^b f\,\mathrm{d}\alpha$	Riemann–Stieltjes integral of f over $[a, b]$ with respect to α

Notation	Meaning
$\mathcal{R}([a,b],\alpha)$	Functions Riemann–Stieltjes integrable on $[a,b]$ with respect to α
$P=\{x_0,\ldots,x_n\}$	Partition of $[a,b]$, with $a=x_0<\cdots<x_n=b$
$\sum_{i=1}^{n} f(\xi_i)\Delta x_i$	Tagged Riemann sum with sample points ξ_i and subinterval widths Δx_i
$\iint_D f\ \mathrm{d}A$	Double integral over D
$\iiint_\Omega f\ \mathrm{d}V$	Triple integral over Ω
$\int_C f(z)\ \mathrm{d}z$	Complex line integral along C
$\oint_C$	Integral along a closed curve C
$\operatorname{Ind}(\gamma,z)$	Winding number of the closed curve γ about z
$-C$	The contour C with the opposite orientation
γ^{-1}	Reversed parametrized path γ
PV, P.V.	Principal value (in particular, Cauchy principal value)
$\sum_{k=1}^{n} a_k$	Finite sum
$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$	Infinite series
$\prod_{k=1}^{n} a_k$	Finite product
$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x-a)^n$	Power series centered at a
$\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} a_n(z-z_0)^n$	Laurent series centered at z_0
$\sum_{k=0}^{n} \frac{f^{(k)}(a)}{k!}(x-a)^k$	nth Taylor polynomial of f about a
$\widehat{f}(n)$	nth complex Fourier coefficient: $\widehat{f}(n)=\frac{1}{2\pi}\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f(x)e^{-inx}\ \mathrm{d}x$
$S_N f$	Nth symmetric Fourier partial sum: $S_N f(x)=\sum_{n=-N}^{N}\widehat{f}(n)e^{inx}$
$\sigma_N f$	Nth Fejèr mean: $\sigma_N f(x)=\frac{1}{N+1}\sum_{k=0}^{N} S_k f(x)$
e^x, $\exp x$	Exponential function
$\ln x$, $\log_e x$	Natural logarithm of a positive real number
$\lg x$, $\log_{10} x$	Logarithm to base 10
$\operatorname{lb} x$, $\log_2 x$	Logarithm to base 2
$\log_a x$	Logarithm to base a
$W_k(z)$	kth branch of the Lambert W-function; W_0 is the principal branch
$\sin x$	Sine
$\cos x$	Cosine
$\tan x$	Tangent
$\csc x$	Cosecant
$\sec x$	Secant
$\cot x$	Cotangent
$\arcsin x$, $\sin^{-1} x$	Principal inverse sine, $[-1,1]\to[-\pi/2,\pi/2]$
$\arccos x$, $\cos^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cosine, $[-1,1]\to[0,\pi]$

Notation	Meaning
$\arctan x,\ \tan^{-1} x$	Principal inverse tangent, $\mathbb{R} \to (-\pi/2, \pi/2)$
$\operatorname{arccsc} x,\ \csc^{-1} x$	Principal inverse cosecant with range $[-\pi/2, 0) \cup (0, \pi/2]$
$\operatorname{arcsec} x,\ \sec^{-1} x$	Principal inverse secant with range $[0, \pi/2) \cup (\pi/2, \pi]$
$\operatorname{arccot} x,\ \cot^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse cotangent, $\mathbb{R} \to (0, \pi)$
$\sinh x$	Hyperbolic sine
$\cosh x$	Hyperbolic cosine
$\tanh x$	Hyperbolic tangent
$\operatorname{csch} x$	Hyperbolic cosecant
$\operatorname{sech} x$	Hyperbolic secant
$\coth x$	Hyperbolic cotangent
$\operatorname{arcsinh} x,\ \sinh^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse hyperbolic sine, $\mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$
$\operatorname{arccosh} x,\ \cosh^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse hyperbolic cosine, $[1, \infty) \to [0, \infty)$
$\operatorname{arctanh} x,\ \tanh^{-1} x$	Principal real inverse hyperbolic tangent, $(-1, 1) \to \mathbb{R}$
$\operatorname{arccsch} x,\ \operatorname{csch}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cosecant
$\operatorname{arcsech} x,\ \operatorname{sech}^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic secant
$\operatorname{arccoth} x,\ \coth^{-1} x$	Principal inverse hyperbolic cotangent
$\Gamma(z)$	Gamma function
$\psi(z)$	Digamma function, $\psi(z) = \Gamma'(z)/\Gamma(z)$
$B(x, y)$	Beta function
γ	Euler–Mascheroni constant
$\zeta(s)$	Riemann zeta function
$\mathbf{J_F}(\mathbf{a}),\ D\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{a})$	Jacobian matrix of $\mathbf{F}$ at $\mathbf{a}$
$\det \mathbf{J_F}(\mathbf{a}),\ \det D\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{a})$	Jacobian determinant of $\mathbf{F}$ at $\mathbf{a}$
$\operatorname{Hess} f$	Hessian matrix of f
$\nabla f,\ \operatorname{grad} f$	Gradient of f
$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{F},\ \operatorname{div} \mathbf{F}$	Divergence of $\mathbf{F}$
$\nabla \times \mathbf{F},\ \operatorname{curl} \mathbf{F}$	Curl of $\mathbf{F}$
Δf	Laplacian of f
$\mathbf{r}(t)$	Parametrized curve
$\mathrm{d}s$	Element of arc length
$\displaystyle\int_C f\ \mathrm{d}s$	Scalar line integral along C with respect to arc length
$\displaystyle\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathrm{d}\mathbf{r}$	Line integral of the vector field $\mathbf{F}$ along C
$\displaystyle\iint_S f\ \mathrm{d}S$	Scalar surface integral over S
$\displaystyle\oiint_S$	Surface integral over a closed surface S
$\displaystyle\iint_S \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{n}\ \mathrm{d}S$	Flux integral through S
$\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = x,\ x_n \to x$	Convergence of a sequence
(x_{n_k})	Subsequence of the sequence (x_n)
$a_n \nearrow L$	Monotone increasing convergence to L
$a_n \searrow L$	Monotone decreasing convergence to L
$\limsup_{n\to\infty} a_n$	Limit superior of the sequence (a_n)
$\liminf_{n\to\infty} a_n$	Limit inferior of the sequence (a_n)
$f(x) \sim g(x)$	Asymptotic equivalence in the stated limiting regime, typically meaning $f(x)/g(x) \to 1$

Notation	Meaning
$f_n \to f,\ f_n \xrightarrow{\text{ptw}} f$	Pointwise convergence of f_n to f
$f_n \rightrightarrows f,\ f_n \xrightarrow{\text{unif}} f$	Uniform convergence
$f_n \xrightarrow{\text{a.e.}} f$	Convergence almost everywhere
$(X, \mathcal{A}, \mu)$	Measure space X with σ-algebra $\mathcal{A}$ and measure μ
$\mathcal{A}$	σ-algebra of measurable subsets of X, when the underlying set is understood
$\mathcal{B}(X)$	Borel σ-algebra of a topological space X
$\mu(E)$	Measure of a measurable set $E \in \mathcal{A}$
$\int_E f \, \mathrm{d}\mu$	Integral of f over E with respect to the measure μ
$f = g$ a.e., $\quad f = g$ μ-a.e.	Equality almost everywhere, with the measure omitted when understood
$\operatorname{ess\,sup}_{x \in E} f(x)$	Essential supremum of f on E
$\operatorname{ess\,inf}_{x \in E} f(x)$	Essential infimum of f on E
$C(\Omega),\ C^0(\Omega)$	Continuous functions on Ω
$C^k(\Omega)$	k times continuously differentiable functions on Ω
$C^\infty(\Omega)$	Smooth functions on Ω
$C_b(X)$	Bounded continuous scalar-valued functions on X; the scalar field is given by context, or explicitly by $C_b(X, \mathbb{R})$ or $C_b(X, \mathbb{C})$. If K is compact, $C_b(K) = C(K)$ for the same codomain
$\operatorname{supp} f$	Support of f, the closure of the set on which f is nonzero
$C_c(\Omega),\ C_c^\infty(\Omega)$	Continuous and smooth functions on Ω with compact support, respectively
$\mathcal{O}(U)$	Holomorphic functions on an open set $U \subseteq \mathbb{C}$
$V_a^b(f)$	Total variation of f on $[a, b]$: $\sup_P \sum_{i=1}^{n} \lvert f(x_i) - f(x_{i-1}) \rvert$, over partitions $P = (a = x_0 < \cdots < x_n = b)$
$\mathrm{BV}([a, b])$	Space of functions of bounded variation on $[a, b]$, namely those f with $V_a^b(f) < \infty$
$\mathcal{R}([a, b])$	Riemann-integrable scalar-valued functions on $[a, b]$; equivalently $\mathcal{R}([a, b], \mathrm{id})$ for the identity integrator $\mathrm{id}(x) = x$
$\mathcal{R}([a, b], \alpha)$	Riemann–Stieltjes-integrable scalar-valued functions on $[a, b]$ with respect to a nondecreasing real-valued function $\alpha\colon [a, b] \to \mathbb{R}$; α need not be continuous, and complex-valued integrands are handled componentwise
$L^p(\Omega),\ L^p(X, \mu)$	Lebesgue L^p spaces of measurable functions modulo equality almost everywhere; the measure is displayed when not understood. For $1 \le p < \infty$, membership requires $\int_X \lvert f \rvert^p \, \mathrm{d}\mu < \infty$
$L^\infty(\Omega),\ L^\infty(X, \mu)$	Lebesgue spaces of essentially bounded measurable functions, identified up to equality almost everywhere
ℓ^p	Space of scalar sequences (x_n) with $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \lvert x_n \rvert^p < \infty$, for $1 \le p < \infty$
ℓ^∞	Space of bounded scalar sequences
$\lVert f \rVert_\infty$	Supremum norm $\sup_{x \in X} \lvert f(x) \rvert$ for an actual bounded scalar-valued function on X
$\lVert f \rVert_{L^p(X,\mu)}$	L^p-norm $\left(\int_X \lvert f \rvert^p \, \mathrm{d}\mu \right)^{1/p}$ for $1 \le p < \infty$ on a measure space $(X, \mathcal{A}, \mu)$

Notation	Meaning
$\|f\|_{L^p(\Omega)},\ \|f\|_p$	L^p-norm $\left(\int_\Omega \|f(\mathbf{x})\|^p \, d\mathbf{x}\right)^{1/p}$ for $1 \le p < \infty$ on a Euclidean domain when the underlying measure is understood
$\|f\|_{L^\infty(\Omega)}$	L^∞-norm $\operatorname{ess\,sup}_{\mathbf{x}\in\Omega} \|f(\mathbf{x})\|$ on a Euclidean domain; distinguished from the ordinary supremum norm
$\alpha = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$	Multi-index
$\|\alpha\|,\ \alpha!$	Order $\|\alpha\| = \alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_n$ and factorial $\alpha! = \alpha_1! \cdots \alpha_n!$ of a multi-index
$\mathbf{x}^\alpha = x_1^{\alpha_1} \cdots x_n^{\alpha_n}$	Multi-index monomial for $\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \ldots, x_n)$
$D^\alpha f,\ \partial^\alpha f$	Mixed partial derivative specified by the multi-index α
$B_r(x)$	Open ball of radius r centered at x
$\overline{B}_r(x) = \{y \mid d(x,y) \le r\}$	Closed ball of radius r centered at x in a metric space (X, d). The bar is part of the closed-ball notation; in an arbitrary metric space, $\overline{B}_r(x)$ need not equal the closure $\overline{B_r(x)}$ of the open ball
$\widehat{\mathbb{C}} = \mathbb{C} \cup \{\infty\}$	Extended complex plane, equivalently the Riemann sphere
$i^2 = -1$	Imaginary unit
$z = x + iy$	Complex number with real part x and imaginary part y
$\operatorname{Re} z,\ \Re z$	Real part of z
$\operatorname{Im} z,\ \Im z$	Imaginary part of z; distinct from lowercase im for image
$\overline{z}$	Complex conjugate
$\|z\|$	Complex modulus
$\arg z$	Argument of a nonzero complex number z; its values differ by integer multiples of 2π
$\operatorname{Arg} z$	Principal argument of $z \neq 0$, with $-\pi < \operatorname{Arg} z \le \pi$
$\log z,\ \ln z$	General multivalued complex logarithm for $z \neq 0$; $\log z = \{\ln \|z\| + i(\operatorname{Arg} z + 2\pi k) \mid k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$
$\operatorname{Log} z,\ \operatorname{Ln} z$	Principal complex logarithm for $z \neq 0$; $\operatorname{Log} z = \ln \|z\| + i \operatorname{Arg} z$. On $\mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0]$, it is the analytic principal branch, with $-\pi < \operatorname{Arg} z < \pi$
$\operatorname{Res}(f; a),\ \operatorname{Res}_{z=a} f(z)$	Residue of f at a finite point a
$\operatorname{Res}(f; \infty),\ \operatorname{Res}_{z=\infty} f(z)$	Residue of f at infinity

5 Linear Algebra

Notation	Meaning
$M_{m\times n}(F),\ F^{m\times n}$	Space of $m \times n$ matrices over the field F
$M_n(F)$	Space (and matrix algebra) of $n \times n$ matrices over F
$\mathbf{A} = (a_{ij}),\ \mathbf{A} = [a_{ij}]$	Matrix with (i,j)-entry a_{ij}
$\mathbf{A}^\mathsf{T}$	Transpose of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A}^\mathsf{H}$	Conjugate transpose of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A}^{-1}$	Inverse of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{I}_n,\ \mathbf{I}$	Identity matrix
$\mathbf{0}$	Zero vector or zero matrix, with dimension understood
$\mathbf{e}_i$	ith standard basis vector
$\mathbf{i},\ \mathbf{j},\ \mathbf{k}$	Standard basis vectors of $\mathbb{R}^3$, along the x-, y-, and z-axes, respectively
$\mathbf{1}$	All-ones vector
$\mathbf{D}$	Diagonal matrix

Notation	Meaning
$\operatorname{diag}(d_1, \ldots, d_n)$	Diagonal matrix with entries $d_1, \ldots, d_n$
$\mathbf{P}$	Projection matrix
$\det(\mathbf{A}),\ \lvert\mathbf{A}\rvert$	Determinant
$\operatorname{rk}(\mathbf{A}),\ \operatorname{rank}(\mathbf{A})$	Rank
$\operatorname{tr}(\mathbf{A}),\ \operatorname{trace}(\mathbf{A})$	Trace
$\operatorname{adj}(\mathbf{A})$	Adjugate matrix
M_{ij}	Minor of the (i,j)-entry
$C_{ij} = (-1)^{i+j} M_{ij}$	Cofactor of the (i,j)-entry
$\operatorname{Col}(\mathbf{A})$	Column space
$\operatorname{Row}(\mathbf{A})$	Row space
$\ker \mathbf{A},\ \operatorname{Null}(\mathbf{A})$	Null space of $\mathbf{A}$
V, W	Vector spaces, usually over an understood field F
$\operatorname{Hom}_F(V,W)$	Vector space of F-linear maps from V to W
$\mathcal{L}(X,Y)$	Bounded linear maps between normed spaces X and Y
$\lVert T\rVert_{\text{op}}$	Operator norm $\sup_{\lVert x\rVert \le 1} \lVert Tx\rVert$ of a bounded linear map $T\colon X \to Y$
$\lVert\mathbf{A}\rVert_{\text{F}}$	Frobenius norm of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A} \otimes \mathbf{B}$	Kronecker product of matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$
$\operatorname{End}_F(V)$	F-algebra of F-linear endomorphisms of V
$\dim V$	Dimension of V
$\operatorname{span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{v}_k)$	Span of the listed vectors
$U \oplus V$	Direct sum
V/U	Quotient vector space of V by its vector subspace $U \subseteq V$; elements are cosets $\mathbf{v} + U$
$\ker T$	Kernel of a linear map T
$\operatorname{nullity}(T) = \dim \ker T$	Nullity of a linear map T
$\operatorname{im} T$	Image of a linear map T
$\mathcal{B} = (\mathbf{b}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{b}_n)$	Ordered basis
$[\mathbf{v}]_{\mathcal{B}}$	Coordinate vector of $\mathbf{v}$ with respect to the ordered basis $\mathcal{B}$
$[T]_{\mathcal{C} \leftarrow \mathcal{B}}$	Matrix of $T\colon V \to W$ relative to domain basis $\mathcal{B}$ and codomain basis $\mathcal{C}$
$[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$	Matrix of an endomorphism $T\colon V \to V$ when the same basis $\mathcal{B}$ is used in the domain and codomain
$\mathbf{P}_{\mathcal{C} \leftarrow \mathcal{B}}$	Change-of-coordinate matrix from basis $\mathcal{B}$ to basis $\mathcal{C}$
V^*	Algebraic dual of a vector space V; for a normed space X, X^* usually denotes the continuous dual
$\langle \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \rangle,\ (\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v})$	Inner product. Over complex spaces, the inner product is conjugate-linear in the first argument and linear in the second
$\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v},\ \mathbf{u}^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{v}$	Standard Euclidean inner product on $\mathbb{R}^n$
$\mathbf{u}^{\mathsf{H}}\mathbf{v}$	Standard Hermitian inner product on $\mathbb{C}^n$
$\lVert\mathbf{v}\rVert$	Norm of $\mathbf{v}$
$\mathbf{u} \perp \mathbf{v}$	Orthogonality
$U^{\perp}$	Orthogonal complement of the subspace U
$\operatorname{proj}_U \mathbf{x}$	Orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto the subspace U
$\operatorname{proj}_{\mathbf{v}} \mathbf{x}$	Orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{x}$ onto $\operatorname{span}(\mathbf{v})$
$\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{v}$	Cross product in $\mathbb{R}^3$
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathsf{T}} = \mathbf{A}$	Real symmetric matrix
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathsf{T}} = -\mathbf{A}$	Real skew-symmetric matrix

Notation	Meaning
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathsf{H}} = \mathbf{A}$	Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A}^{\mathsf{H}} = -\mathbf{A}$	Skew-Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{Q}^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{I}$	Real orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{Q}$
$\mathbf{U}^{\mathsf{H}}\mathbf{U} = \mathbf{I}$	Unitary matrix $\mathbf{U}$
$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^{\mathsf{H}} = \mathbf{A}^{\mathsf{H}}\mathbf{A}$	Normal matrix
$\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P}$	Projection matrix
$\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P} = \mathbf{P}^{\mathsf{T}}$	Orthogonal projection matrix over $\mathbb{R}$
$\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P} = \mathbf{P}^{\mathsf{H}}$	Orthogonal projection matrix over $\mathbb{C}$
$\chi_{\mathbf{A}}(t),\ p_{\mathbf{A}}(t)$	Characteristic polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$, with $\chi_{\mathbf{A}}(t) = \det(t\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{A})$
$m_{\mathbf{A}}(t),\ \mu_{\mathbf{A}}(t)$	Minimal polynomial of $\mathbf{A}$
$\lambda,\ \lambda_i$	Eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{v},\ \mathbf{v}_i$	Eigenvector of $\mathbf{A}$
$E_\lambda(\mathbf{A}),\ V_\lambda(\mathbf{A})$	Eigenspace of $\mathbf{A}$ associated with λ
$\mathbf{J}_k(\lambda)$	Jordan block of size k with eigenvalue λ
$\sigma(\mathbf{A}),\ \operatorname{spec}(\mathbf{A})$	Spectrum of $\mathbf{A}$
$\rho(\mathbf{A})$	Spectral radius
$\mathbf{P}_\lambda$	Spectral projection associated with the eigenvalue λ
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{P}\mathbf{D}\mathbf{P}^{-1}$	Diagonalization of a diagonalizable matrix
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{D}\mathbf{Q}^{\mathsf{T}}$	Orthogonal diagonalization of a real symmetric matrix
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U}\mathbf{D}\mathbf{U}^{\mathsf{H}}$	Unitary diagonalization of a complex normal matrix
$\mathbf{A} = \sum_{\lambda \in \sigma(\mathbf{A})} \lambda \mathbf{P}_\lambda$	Spectral decomposition of $\mathbf{A}$
$e^{\mathbf{A}},\ \exp(\mathbf{A})$	Matrix exponential
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{L}\mathbf{U}$	LU factorization, with $\mathbf{L}$ lower triangular and $\mathbf{U}$ upper triangular
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{R}$	QR factorization
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U}\mathbf{\Sigma}\mathbf{V}^{\mathsf{H}}$	Singular value decomposition (SVD) of $\mathbf{A}$
$\sigma_i(\mathbf{A})$	ith singular value of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A}^{\dagger}$	Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse of $\mathbf{A}$
$\mathbf{A} \succ 0$	Positive definite Hermitian matrix (real symmetric in the real case)
$\mathbf{A} \succeq 0$	Positive semidefinite Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A} \prec 0$	Negative definite Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A} \preceq 0$	Negative semidefinite Hermitian matrix
$\mathbf{A} \succeq \mathbf{B}$	Löwner order: $\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{B} \succeq 0$, for Hermitian matrices of the same size
$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{L}\mathbf{L}^{\mathsf{H}}$	Cholesky factorization of a positive definite Hermitian matrix

6 Differential Equations

Notation	Meaning
y'	First derivative
y''	Second derivative
$\dot{x}$	First derivative of x with respect to time
$\ddot{x}$	Second derivative of x with respect to time
$F(t, y, y', \ldots, y^{(n)}) = 0$	General nth-order ordinary differential equation
$y^{(n)} = f(t, y, \ldots, y^{(n-1)})$	nth-order ordinary differential equation in normal form
$y(t_0) = y_0$	Initial condition for a scalar differential equation
$y' + p(t)y = g(t)$	Standard form of a first-order linear differential equation

Notation	Meaning
$\mu(t)$	Integrating factor for a first-order linear differential equation
$M(x,y)\ \mathrm{d}x + N(x,y)\ \mathrm{d}y = 0$	Differential form of a first-order differential equation
M_x, M_y, N_x, N_y	Subscript notation for the corresponding partial derivatives
$L[y]$	Linear differential operator applied to y
$L[y] = \sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k(t) y^{(k)}$	General nth-order linear differential operator, with $a_n \not\equiv 0$
$L[y] = 0,\ L[y] = g$	Homogeneous and nonhomogeneous linear differential equations, respectively
$y_h,\ y_c$	Homogeneous or complementary part of a solution
y_p	Particular solution
$c_1, c_2, \ldots$	Arbitrary constants in a general solution
$\sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k r^k = 0$	Characteristic equation for a constant-coefficient homogeneous linear differential equation
$r_1, \ldots, r_n$	Characteristic roots
$W(y_1, \ldots, y_n)(t)$	Wronskian of $y_1, \ldots, y_n$
$y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x - x_0)^n$	Power-series form about the ordinary point x_0
$y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x - x_0)^{n+r}$	Frobenius-series form about a regular singular point x_0; r denotes an indicial exponent
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{f}(t, \mathbf{x})$	General first-order system
$\mathbf{x}(t_0) = \mathbf{x}_0$	Initial condition for a first-order system
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{g}(t)$, $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{g}(t)$	Linear first-order system in state-vector form
$\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x})$	Autonomous first-order system
$\mathbf{x}_e$	Equilibrium point of an autonomous system
$\mathbf{\Phi}(t)$	Fundamental matrix of a linear system
$\mathcal{L}\{f(t)\}(s),\ \mathcal{L}[f](s)$	Laplace transform of f
$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\{F(s)\}(t),\ \mathcal{L}^{-1}[F](t)$	Inverse Laplace transform of F
$(f * g)(t)$	One-sided convolution of f and g
$H(t-a),\ u(t-a)$	Heaviside or unit-step function shifted to $t = a$; its value at the jump is specified when relevant
$\delta(t),\ \delta(t-a)$	Dirac delta distribution, or unit impulse, centered at 0 or shifted to $t = a$
$u_x, u_t, u_{xx}, u_{xy}, u_{tt}, \ldots$	Subscript notation for partial derivatives of a scalar function u
$\partial_{\mathbf{n}} u$	Normal derivative of u in the direction of the unit normal $\mathbf{n}$
$u\vert_{\partial\Omega} = g$	Dirichlet boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$
$\partial_{\mathbf{n}} u\vert_{\partial\Omega} = g$	Neumann boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$
$\alpha u + \beta\, \partial_{\mathbf{n}} u = g$	Robin boundary condition on $\partial\Omega$
$a_n,\ b_n$	Fourier coefficients of a real $2L$-periodic function
a_n	$a_n = \frac{1}{L}\int_{-L}^{L} f(x) \cos\frac{n\pi x}{L}\ \mathrm{d}x$ for $n \geq 0$
b_n	$b_n = \frac{1}{L}\int_{-L}^{L} f(x) \sin\frac{n\pi x}{L}\ \mathrm{d}x$ for $n \geq 1$
$\widehat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi}),\ \mathcal{F}f(\boldsymbol{\xi})$	Fourier transform: $\widehat{f}(\boldsymbol{\xi}) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(\mathbf{x}) e^{-2\pi i \mathbf{x}\cdot\boldsymbol{\xi}}\ \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}$
$\mathcal{F}^{-1}$	Inverse Fourier transform under the stated normalization
$-(py')' + qy = \lambda w y$	Sturm–Liouville eigenvalue equation, where p, q, and w are functions of x

Notation	Meaning
$\lambda_n,\ \phi_n$	Sturm–Liouville eigenvalue and corresponding eigenfunction
$\langle f, g\rangle_w$	Weighted inner product, $\langle f, g\rangle_w \coloneqq \int_a^b \overline{f(x)} g(x) w(x)\ \mathrm{d}x$
$\langle \phi_m, \phi_n\rangle_w = \delta_{mn}$	Weighted orthonormality of eigenfunctions
$G(x,\xi),\ G(\mathbf{x},\boldsymbol{\xi})$	Green's function
$\mathrm{Ai}(x),\ \mathrm{Bi}(x)$	Airy functions
$J_\nu(x)$	Bessel function of the first kind of order ν
$Y_\nu(x),\ N_\nu(x)$	Bessel function of the second kind of order ν
$I_\nu(x),\ K_\nu(x)$	Modified Bessel functions of the first and second kinds
$H_\nu^{(1)}(x),\ H_\nu^{(2)}(x)$	Hankel functions of the first and second kinds
$P_n(x)$	Legendre polynomial of degree n
$P_\nu(x),\ Q_\nu(x)$	Legendre functions of the first and second kinds
$P_\ell^m(x)$	Associated Legendre function for integer degree ℓ and order m
$H_n(x),\ \mathrm{He}_n(x)$	Physicists' and probabilists' Hermite polynomials, respectively
$L_n^{(\alpha)}(x),\ L_n(x)$	Generalized and ordinary Laguerre polynomials
$T_n(x),\ U_n(x)$	Chebyshev polynomials of the first and second kinds
$P_n^{(\alpha,\beta)}(x)$	Jacobi polynomial
$C_n^{(\lambda)}(x)$	Gegenbauer (ultraspherical) polynomial
$\mathrm{erf}(x),\ \mathrm{erfc}(x)$	Error function and complementary error function
${}_2F_1(a,b;c;z)$	Gauss hypergeometric function

7 Numerical Analysis

Notation	Meaning
$\mathrm{fl}(x)$	Floating-point representation of x
u	Unit roundoff
$\varepsilon_{\mathrm{mach}}$	Machine epsilon (floating-point spacing above 1)
$\kappa(\mathbf{A})$	Condition number of $\mathbf{A}$ in the chosen norm
$x^{(k)}$	kth iterate of a numerical method
$e^{(k)} = x^{(k)} - x^*$	Error of the kth iterate relative to x^*
$\mathbf{r}^{(k)} = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}^{(k)}$	Residual of the kth approximation to $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$
h	Step size
$t_n = t_0 + nh$	Uniform grid with step size h
$y_n \approx y(t_n)$	Numerical approximation to $y(t_n)$
$x_{k+1} = x_k - \dfrac{f(x_k)}{f'(x_k)}$	Newton iteration for $f(x) = 0$
$y_{n+1} = y_n + hf(t_n, y_n)$	Forward (explicit) Euler method for $y' = f(t, y)$
$f[x_0, \ldots, x_n]$	Divided difference of f at the nodes $x_0, \ldots, x_n$
$\sum_{i=0}^{n} w_i f(x_i)$	Quadrature rule with nodes x_i and weights w_i

8 Combinatorics and Discrete Mathematics

Notation	Meaning
$[n] = \{1, 2, \ldots, n\}$	Standard n-element set; $[0] = \varnothing$ when needed
$n!$	Factorial
$n!!$	Double factorial: product of positive integers of the same parity not exceeding n, with $0!! = (-1)!! = 1$
$n^{\underline{k}}$	Falling factorial, $n(n-1)\cdots(n-k+1)$
$n^{\overline{k}}$	Rising factorial, $n(n+1)\cdots(n+k-1)$
$(a)_k$	Rising Pochhammer symbol $a(a+1)\cdots(a+k-1)$ in special-functions contexts
${}_nP_r$	Number of ordered selections of r distinct elements from an n-element set, ${}_nP_r = \dfrac{n!}{(n-r)!}$ for $0 \le r \le n$
$\binom{n}{r}$, ${}_nC_r$	Number of r-element subsets of an n-element set
$\left(\binom{n}{r}\right)$, ${}_nH_r$	r-combinations with repetition from n types; equals $\binom{n+r-1}{r}$
$\binom{n}{n_1, \ldots, n_k}$	Multinomial coefficient, for nonnegative integers $n_1, \ldots, n_k$ with $n_1 + \cdots + n_k = n$
$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}$, $c(n,k)$	Unsigned Stirling number of the first kind; permutations of n elements with k cycles
$s(n,k)$	Signed Stirling number of the first kind; $s(n,k) = (-1)^{n-k}c(n,k)$
$\left\{ n \atop k \right\}$, $S(n,k)$	Stirling number of the second kind; partitions of an n-element set into k nonempty blocks
D_n, $!n$	Number of derangements of n elements; permutations with no fixed points
C_n	nth Catalan number, $C_n = \dfrac{1}{n+1}\binom{2n}{n}$ for $n \ge 0$
B_n	nth Bell number; number of partitions of an n-element set
$p(n)$	Number of integer partitions of n, with $p(0) = 1$
$H_n = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \dfrac{1}{k}$	nth harmonic number for $n \ge 1$, with $H_0 = 0$
$(X, \preceq)$	Partially ordered set (poset)
$\prec$, $\succeq$, $\succ$	Strict and reverse order relations associated with $\preceq$
$\le_{\text{lex}}$	Lexicographic order
$x \lessdot y$	Cover relation: y covers x
B_n	Boolean lattice (Boolean poset) on an n-element ground set
$G = (V, E)$	Graph with vertex set V and edge set E
$V(G)$	Vertex set of G
$E(G)$	Edge set of G
$N(v)$, $\Gamma(v)$	Neighborhood of vertex v
$N[v] = N(v) \cup \{v\}$	Closed neighborhood of the vertex v
$\deg_G(v)$, $\deg(v)$	Degree of vertex v
$\deg^+(v)$, $\deg^-(v)$	Out-degree and in-degree of v in a directed graph
$\delta(G)$, $\Delta(G)$	Minimum and maximum vertex degrees, respectively, of a nonempty finite graph G
$d_G(u,v)$, $d(u,v)$	Graph distance between vertices u and v
$G[S]$	Subgraph of G induced by the vertex set $S \subseteq V(G)$

Notation	Meaning
$G - v,\ G - S$	Graph obtained by deleting the vertex v, or all vertices in S, together with their incident edges
$G - e$	Graph obtained by deleting the edge e
G/e	Graph obtained by contracting the edge e
$\overline{G}$	Complement of the graph G
K_n	Complete graph on n vertices
$K_{m,n}$	Complete bipartite graph with parts of sizes m and n
P_n	Path graph on n vertices
C_n	Cycle graph on n vertices
$\mathbf{A}(G),\ \mathbf{A}_G$	Adjacency matrix of G
$\mathbf{D}(G),\ \mathbf{D}_G$	Degree matrix of G, the diagonal matrix of vertex degrees in the chosen vertex order
$\mathbf{L}(G),\ \mathbf{L}_G$	Graph Laplacian, usually $\mathbf{D}(G) - \mathbf{A}(G)$
$\chi(G)$	Chromatic number of G
$P_G(k)$	Chromatic polynomial of G, counting proper colorings with k labeled colors
$\nu(G)$	Matching number of G: the maximum size of a matching (a set of pairwise vertex-disjoint edges)
$\alpha(G)$	Independence number of G: maximum size of an independent vertex set
$\omega(G)$	Clique number of G: maximum size of a complete vertex set
$\mathrm{Aut}(G)$	Automorphism group of the graph G
$\tau(G),\ T(G)$	Number of spanning trees of G
$R(k,\ell),\ r(k,\ell),\ R(k),\ r(k)$	Ramsey numbers; $R(k) = R(k,k)$ in the diagonal case
$A(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$	Ordinary generating function of the sequence $(a_n)_{n\geq 0}$
$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n \frac{x^n}{n!}$	Exponential generating function of the sequence $(a_n)_{n\geq 0}$
$[x^n]F(x)$	Coefficient of x^n in the formal power series or generating function $F(x)$

9 Probability and Statistics

Notation	Meaning
$(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{P})$	Probability space, with sample space Ω, event σ-algebra $\mathcal{F}$, and probability measure $\mathbb{P}$
$\omega \in \Omega$	Outcome or sample point
$A \in \mathcal{F}$	Event
$X : \Omega \to \mathbb{R}$	Real-valued random variable; measurability from $(\Omega, \mathcal{F})$ to $(\mathbb{R}, \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R}))$ is understood
$\mathbb{P}(A)$	Probability of event A
$\mathbb{P}(A \mid B)$	Conditional probability of A given B
$X \perp\!\!\!\perp Y$	X and Y are independent.
$X \perp\!\!\!\perp Y \mid Z$	X and Y are conditionally independent given Z.
$p_X(x) = \mathbb{P}(X = x)$	Probability mass function (pmf) of a discrete random variable X
$f_X(x)$	Probability density function (pdf) of X
$F_X(x) = \mathbb{P}(X \leq x)$	Cumulative distribution function (cdf) of X

Notation	Meaning
$p_{X,Y}(x,y),\ f_{X,Y}(x,y)$	Joint pmf or joint pdf of (X,Y)
$p_{X\mid Y}(x\mid y),\ f_{X\mid Y}(x\mid y)$	Conditional pmf or conditional pdf of X given $Y=y$
$F^{-1}(p)$	Generalized inverse of a cdf F, $F^{-1}(p)=\inf\{x\in\mathbb{R}\mid F(x)\geq p\}$; the p-quantile, for $0<p<1$
$\mathbb{E}[X]$	Expectation of random variable X
$\mathbb{E}[X\mid Y]$	Conditional expectation of X given Y
$\mathbb{E}[X\mid\mathcal{G}]$	Conditional expectation of X with respect to a sub-σ-algebra $\mathcal{G}\subseteq\mathcal{F}$
$\mathrm{Var}(X)$	Variance of X
$\sigma_X=\sqrt{\mathrm{Var}(X)}$	Population standard deviation of X
$\mathrm{Cov}(X,Y)$	Covariance of X and Y
$\mathbf{\Sigma}=\mathrm{Cov}(\mathbf{X})$	Covariance matrix of the random vector $\mathbf{X}$
$\rho_{X,Y},\ \mathrm{Corr}(X,Y)$	Pearson correlation coefficient of X and Y
r	Sample correlation coefficient
$\varphi_X(t)=\mathbb{E}[e^{itX}]$	Characteristic function of X
$M_X(t)=\mathbb{E}[e^{tX}]$	Moment-generating function (mgf) of X, when finite in a neighborhood of 0
$\bar{X}=\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}X_i$	Sample mean as a statistic of a random sample $X_1,\dots,X_n$
$\bar{x}=\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}x_i$	Observed sample mean for data $x_1,\dots,x_n$
$S^2=\frac{1}{n-1}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(X_i-\bar{X})^2$	Sample variance as a statistic, for $n\geq 2$
$s^2=\frac{1}{n-1}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i-\bar{x})^2$	Observed sample variance, for $n\geq 2$
$S=\sqrt{S^2},\ s=\sqrt{s^2}$	Sample standard deviation as a statistic and its observed value
$\hat{\theta}$	Estimator or estimate of a parameter θ
$\mathrm{Bias}(\hat{\theta})$	Bias of a real-valued estimator of θ: $\mathbb{E}[\hat{\theta}]-\theta$, when the expectation exists
$\mathrm{MSE}(\hat{\theta})$	Mean squared error of the estimator $\hat{\theta}$
$\hat{p}$	Estimator or estimate of a probability parameter p; commonly the sample proportion
$\mathrm{SE}(\hat{\theta})$	Standard error of an estimator $\hat{\theta}$
$L(\theta;\mathbf{x})$	Likelihood function for parameter θ given observed data $\mathbf{x}$
$\ell(\theta;\mathbf{x})=\ln L(\theta;\mathbf{x})$	Log-likelihood function
H_0	Null hypothesis
$H_1,\ H_a$	Alternative hypothesis
α	Significance level of a hypothesis test
β	Type II error probability of a hypothesis test
ν	Degrees of freedom
$X\sim\mathrm{Bern}(p)$	Bernoulli distribution with success probability p
$X\sim\mathrm{Bin}(n,p)$	Binomial distribution
$X\sim\mathrm{Hypergeom}(N,K,n)$	Hypergeometric distribution: n draws from N items, K of which are successes
$X\sim\mathrm{Geom}(p)$	Geometric distribution on $\mathbb{N}$, counting trials up to and including the first success; $\mathbb{P}(X=k)=(1-p)^{k-1}p$ for $k\in\mathbb{N}$
$X\sim\mathrm{Pois}(\lambda)$	Poisson distribution with parameter λ
$X\sim\mathrm{Unif}(a,b)$	Continuous uniform distribution on $[a,b]$
$X\sim\mathrm{Exp}(\lambda)$	Exponential distribution with rate λ

Notation	Meaning
$X \sim \Gamma(\alpha, \beta)$	Gamma distribution with shape α and rate β
$X \sim \Gamma(\alpha, \theta)$	Gamma distribution with shape α and scale $\theta = 1/\beta$
$X \sim \mathrm{Beta}(\alpha, \beta)$	Beta distribution with shape parameters α and β
$X \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$, $X \sim N(\mu, \sigma^2)$	Normal distribution with mean μ and variance σ^2
$\phi(x)$	Standard normal probability density function, $\phi(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-x^2/2}$
$\Phi(x)$	Standard normal cumulative distribution function, $\Phi(x) = \int_{-\infty}^{x} \phi(t)\ \mathrm{d}t$
$X \sim \chi^2_\nu$	Chi-squared distribution with ν degrees of freedom
$X \sim t_\nu$	Student's t distribution with ν degrees of freedom
$X \sim F_{\nu_1, \nu_2}$	F distribution with numerator and denominator degrees of freedom ν_1, ν_2
$X_n \xrightarrow{\text{a.s.}} X$	Almost-sure convergence
$X_n \xrightarrow{\mathbb{P}} X$	Convergence in probability
$X_n \xrightarrow{L^p} X$	Convergence in L^p
$X \overset{\text{d}}{=} Y$	Equality in distribution of the random variables X and Y
$X_n \xrightarrow{\text{d}} X,\ X_n \Rightarrow X$	Convergence in distribution
$\mathcal{L}(X)$	Distribution (law) of the random variable X

10 Geometry

In triangle notation, A, B, C denote vertices and a, b, c the opposite side lengths. Lowercase letters such as ℓ, m, n may denote lines. The notation $\overrightarrow{AB}$ may denote either the ray from A through B or the vector from A to B, according to context. Greek letters such as ω, Ω, Γ may be used as local names for circles. In differential geometry, the Frenet frame follows the standard uppercase convention $\mathbf{T}, \mathbf{N}, \mathbf{B}$, typeset in bold to emphasize that these are vectors; uppercase italic letters such as X, Y may denote vector fields in the usual field-specific convention.

Notation	Meaning
$\triangle ABC$	Triangle with vertices A, B, C
$\angle ABC$	Geometric angle with vertex B
$m\angle ABC$	Measure of the angle $\angle ABC$
$\angle(\ell, m)$	Directed angle from the line ℓ to the line m, taken modulo π
$\overline{AB}$	Segment joining A and B
AB	Length of $\overline{AB}$
$\overrightarrow{AB}$	Ray from A through B, or vector from A to B, according to context
$\overrightarrow{AB} = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{a}$	Vector from A to B when $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are the corresponding position vectors
$\overleftrightarrow{AB}$	Line through A and B
$\ell \parallel m$	Lines ℓ and m are parallel
$\ell \perp m$	Lines ℓ and m are perpendicular
$\triangle ABC \cong \triangle DEF$	Congruent triangles; corresponding vertices are listed in the same order
$\triangle ABC \sim \triangle DEF$	Similar triangles; corresponding vertices are listed in the same order
$[ABC]$	Area of $\triangle ABC$
$C(O, r)$	Circle with center O and radius r

Notation	Meaning
$\odot O$	Circle centered at O
$\mathrm{Pow}(P, \omega)$	Power of P with respect to a circle ω with center O and radius r: $OP^2 - r^2$
(ABC)	Circle through the noncollinear points A, B, C; in particular, the circumcircle of $\triangle ABC$
$\widehat{AB},\ \widehat{ACB}$	Arcs specified by their endpoints, with an additional point used when needed to distinguish the intended arc
O, I, H, G	Circumcenter, incenter, orthocenter, and centroid of a triangle, respectively
R, r	Circumradius and inradius of a triangle, respectively
$s = \dfrac{a+b+c}{2}$	Semiperimeter of a triangle with side lengths a, b, c
$d(P, Q)$	Distance between the points P and Q
$\mathrm{dist}(P, A)$	Distance from the point P to the set A
$\mathrm{length}(C),\ \ell(C)$	Length of the curve C
$\mathrm{area}(S)$	Area of the surface S
$\mathrm{vol}(\Omega)$	Volume of the region Ω
$\mathrm{diam}(A)$	Diameter of the set A
$\mathrm{conv}(A)$	Convex hull of the set A
$\mathrm{aff}(A)$	Affine hull of the set A
$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{p} + t\mathbf{v}$	Parametric equation of a line through $\mathbf{p}$ in the direction $\mathbf{v}$
$\mathbf{n} \cdot (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{p}) = 0$	Hyperplane through $\mathbf{p}$ with normal vector $\mathbf{n}$
$\mathbb{R}^n$	n-dimensional real Euclidean space
$S^n = \{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^{n+1} \mid \lVert\mathbf{x}\rVert = 1\}$	Unit n-sphere
$S_r^{n-1}(\mathbf{a})$	Sphere of radius r centered at $\mathbf{a} \in \mathbb{R}^n$
$\mathrm{Isom}(X)$	Isometry group of the metric or geometric space X
$\mathbb{RP}^n$	Real projective n-space
$\mathbb{CP}^n$	Complex projective n-space
$[x_0 : \cdots : x_n]$	Homogeneous coordinates in projective space
$\mathbb{H}^n$	n-dimensional hyperbolic space
$d_{\mathbb{H}}$	Hyperbolic distance
$\gamma \colon I \to \mathbb{R}^n$	Parametrized curve, where $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is an interval
$\dot{\gamma}(t)$	Velocity or tangent vector of a differentiable parametrized curve; for a curve in a manifold M, $\dot{\gamma}(t) \in T_{\gamma(t)}M$
s	Arc-length parameter
$\mathbf{T},\ \mathbf{N},\ \mathbf{B}$	Unit tangent, principal normal, and binormal vectors of the Frenet frame
κ	Curvature of a regular curve
τ	Torsion of a space curve
T_pM	Tangent space of the manifold or regular surface M at p
$\mathbf{n} \colon M \to S^2$	Gauss map of an oriented surface $M \subseteq \mathbb{R}^3$, assigning its unit normal vector
I, II	First and second fundamental forms of a regular surface
$\kappa_1,\ \kappa_2$	Principal curvatures of a regular surface
$K = \kappa_1\kappa_2$	Gaussian curvature of a regular surface
$H = \dfrac{\kappa_1 + \kappa_2}{2}$	Mean curvature of a regular surface under the average convention
(M, g)	Riemannian manifold M with Riemannian metric g
g_p	Riemannian inner product on T_pM

Notation	Meaning
$d_g(p, q)$	Riemannian distance between p and q under metric g
$\nabla_X Y$	Covariant derivative of Y along X
Γ_{ij}^k	Christoffel symbols of a connection in local coordinates
$\exp_p \colon \mathcal{D}_p \to M$	Riemannian exponential map at p with domain $\mathcal{D}_p$
$\nabla_{\dot\gamma}\dot\gamma = 0$	Geodesic equation for an affinely parametrized curve γ

11 Number Theory

Notation	Meaning
$a \mid b$	a divides b.
$a \nmid b$	a does not divide b.
$\gcd(a_1, \ldots, a_n),\ (a, b)$	Greatest common divisor; (a, b) for two integers when the context is clear
$\operatorname{lcm}(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$	Least common multiple
$p^k \parallel n$	p^k exactly divides n: $p^k \mid n$ and $p^{k+1} \nmid n$.
$v_p(n),\ \nu_p(n)$	p-adic valuation of n
$a \equiv b \pmod n$	a is congruent to b modulo n.
$[a]_n,\ \overline{a}$	Residue class of a modulo n; $\overline{a}$ when the modulus is clear
$a \bmod n$	Least nonnegative remainder of a modulo n, for $n > 0$
$\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$	Ring of residue classes modulo n
$(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$	Multiplicative group of units modulo n
$a^{-1} \pmod n$	Multiplicative inverse of a modulo n, for $\gcd(a, n) = 1$
$\operatorname{ord}_n(a)$	Multiplicative order of a modulo n, for $\gcd(a, n) = 1$
$\mathbb{F}_q,\ \mathrm{GF}(q)$	Finite field with q elements, where q is a prime power
$\left(\frac{a}{p}\right)$	Legendre symbol, for an odd prime p
$\left(\frac{a}{n}\right)$	Jacobi symbol, for an odd positive integer n
$\chi \pmod q$	Dirichlet character modulo q
$\varphi(n)$	Euler totient function
$\lambda(n)$	Carmichael function of n
B_n	nth Bernoulli number, under the convention $B_1 = -\frac{1}{2}$
$\sum_{d\mid n}$	Sum over the positive divisors d of n
$\prod_{p\mid n}$	Product over the prime divisors p of n
$\sigma_k(n) = \sum_{d\mid n} d^k$	Sum of the kth powers of the positive divisors of n
$\tau(n) = \sigma_0(n),\ d(n)$	Number of positive divisors of n
$\sigma(n) = \sigma_1(n)$	Sum of positive divisors of n
$\mu(n)$	Möbius function
$\omega(n)$	Number of distinct prime divisors of n
$\Omega(n)$	Number of prime factors of n, counted with multiplicity
$\operatorname{rad}(n)$	Product of the distinct prime divisors of n
$(f * g)(n) = \sum_{d\mid n} f(d)g(n/d)$	Dirichlet convolution of arithmetic functions f and g
$\pi(x)$	Number of primes not exceeding x
$\Lambda(n)$	Von Mangoldt function

Notation	Meaning
$L(s, \chi)$	Dirichlet L-function associated with χ
$[a_0; a_1, a_2, \dots]$	Simple continued fraction
$[a_0; a_1, \dots, a_n] = \dfrac{p_n}{q_n}$	nth convergent of a continued fraction
$\Phi_n(x)$	nth cyclotomic polynomial
$\mathbb{Z}[i]$	Ring of Gaussian integers
$K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$	Quadratic field, with squarefree $d \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $d \neq 1$
$\mathcal{O}_K$	Ring of integers of the number field K
$\mathrm{N}(\mathfrak{a}) = \lvert\mathcal{O}_K/\mathfrak{a}\rvert$	Absolute norm of a nonzero integral ideal $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_K$
$D_K,\ \mathrm{disc}(K)$	Discriminant of the number field K
$\mathrm{Cl}(K)$	Ideal class group of the number field K
$h_K = \lvert\mathrm{Cl}(K)\rvert$	Class number of the number field K

12 Algebra

Unless otherwise stated, rings are associative and have an identity, but need not be commutative. Ring homomorphisms preserve identities, ideals are two-sided, and modules are left modules.

Notation	Meaning
G	Group
$e,\ 1_G$	Identity element of a group
$0_G,\ -g$	Identity and inverse notation for an additively written group G
g^{-1}	Inverse of $g \in G$
$\lvert G\rvert$	Order (cardinality) of G
$\mathrm{ord}(g),\ \lvert g\rvert$	Order of the element g
$\langle S \rangle$	Subgroup generated by $S \subseteq G$
$\langle g \rangle$	Cyclic subgroup generated by g
$H \leq G$	H is a subgroup of G.
$H \trianglelefteq G$	H is a normal subgroup of G.
$gH,\ Hg$	Left and right cosets of H in G
$[G : H]$	Index of H in G
G/H	Set of left cosets of $H \leq G$ in G; a quotient group when $H \trianglelefteq G$
$\ker \varphi$	Kernel of the homomorphism φ
$\mathrm{im}\, \varphi$	Image of the homomorphism φ
$\mathrm{Hom}(G, H)$	Set of group homomorphisms from G to H
$\mathrm{Aut}(G)$	Automorphism group of G
$\mathrm{Inn}(G)$	Inner automorphism group of G
$\mathrm{Out}(G)$	Outer automorphism group $\mathrm{Aut}(G)/\mathrm{Inn}(G)$
$Z(G)$	Center of G
$C_G(A),\ C_G(x)$	Centralizer in G of $A \subseteq G$ or $x \in G$
$N_G(A),\ N_G(H)$	Normalizer in G of $A \subseteq G$ or $H \leq G$
$g^G = \{hgh^{-1} \mid h \in G\}$	Conjugacy class of $g \in G$
$[x, y] \coloneqq x^{-1}y^{-1}xy$	Commutator of x and y
$[G, G],\ G'$	Commutator (derived) subgroup of G
$G^{\mathrm{ab}} = G/[G, G]$	Abelianization of G
$\mathrm{Syl}_p(G)$	Set of Sylow p-subgroups of G
n_p	Number of Sylow p-subgroups of G
$G \curvearrowright X$	Action of G on X

Notation	Meaning
$g \cdot x$	Action of $g \in G$ on $x \in X$
$G \cdot x,\ \mathrm{Orb}_G(x),\ \mathrm{Orb}(x)$	Orbit of x under the action of G
$G\backslash X,\ X/G$	Set of orbits of a left G-action on X; X/G is also used when the action convention is clear
$\mathrm{Stab}_G(x),\ G_x$	Stabilizer of x in G
$\mathrm{Fix}(g),\ X^g$	Fixed-point set $\{x \in X \mid g \cdot x = x\}$ of $g \in G$ acting on X
X^H	Common fixed-point set $\{x \in X \mid h \cdot x = x \text{ for all } h \in H\}$ of $H \leq G$
$G \times H$	Direct product of groups
$N \rtimes_\varphi H$	Semidirect product determined by $\varphi\colon H \to \mathrm{Aut}(N)$, with N the normal factor
$\langle S \mid R \rangle$	Group presentation with generators S and relations R
C_n	Cyclic group of order n
D_n	Dihedral group of symmetries of a regular n-gon; $\lvert D_n \rvert = 2n$ (alternative convention: D_{2n})
$\mathrm{Sym}(X)$	Symmetric group of all permutations of the set X
$S_n,\ \mathfrak{S}_n$	Symmetric group on n symbols
$(a_1\, a_2\, \ldots\, a_k)$	Cycle notation for a permutation sending a_i to a_{i+1} for $i < k$ and a_k to a_1
$A_n,\ \mathfrak{A}_n$	Alternating group on n symbols
V_4	Klein four-group
Q_8	Quaternion group of order 8
$\mathrm{GL}_n(F)$	General linear group over F
$\mathrm{SL}_n(F)$	Special linear group over F
$\mathrm{O}(n)$	Orthogonal group of $n \times n$ real matrices
$\mathrm{SO}(n)$	Special orthogonal group; matrices in $\mathrm{O}(n)$ with determinant 1
$\mathrm{U}(n)$	Unitary group of $n \times n$ complex matrices
$\mathrm{SU}(n)$	Special unitary group; matrices in $\mathrm{U}(n)$ with determinant 1
R	Ring
$0_R,\ 1_R$	Additive and multiplicative identities of R
$R^\times$	Group of units of R
$I,\ J,\ \mathfrak{a},\ \mathfrak{b}$	Ideals of R; unless otherwise stated, ideals are two-sided
$\mathfrak{p},\ \mathfrak{q}$	Prime ideals
$\mathrm{Spec}(R)$	Prime spectrum of the commutative ring R
$\mathfrak{m},\ \mathfrak{n}$	Maximal ideals
$\sqrt{I}$	Radical of the ideal I
(a)	Two-sided ideal generated by a; in a commutative ring, the usual principal ideal
$(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$	Two-sided ideal generated by $a_1, \ldots, a_n$
$I + J$	Sum of the ideals I and J
IJ	Product of the ideals I and J
R/I	Quotient ring
$R[x],\ R[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$	Polynomial rings over R in commuting central indeterminates
$R[\alpha]$	Subring generated by R and α in a commutative R-algebra
$\deg f$	Degree of the polynomial f
$\mathrm{disc}(f)$	Discriminant of the polynomial f
$M_n(R)$	Ring of $n \times n$ matrices over R
$R[G]$	Group ring of G over R
$\mathrm{Frac}(R)$	Fraction field of the integral domain R

Notation	Meaning
$S^{-1}R$	Localization of a commutative ring R at a multiplicatively closed subset $S \subseteq R$
$R_{\mathfrak{p}}$	Localization of a commutative ring R at a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$: $(R \setminus \mathfrak{p})^{-1}R$
$\operatorname{char} R$	Characteristic of R
$\mathbb{H}$	Quaternion division algebra over $\mathbb{R}$
$M,\ N$	Left R-modules, unless otherwise stated
${}_RM,\ M_R$	Left and right R-modules, when the side is emphasized
M/N	Quotient module, for a submodule N of M
$M \oplus N$	Direct sum of modules
$\bigoplus_{i \in \Lambda} M_i$	Direct sum of an indexed family of modules, with index set Λ
R^n	Free R-module of rank n
$\operatorname{Hom}_R(M, N)$	Set of R-module homomorphisms from M to N
$\operatorname{End}_R(M)$	Endomorphism ring of the R-module M
$\operatorname{Aut}_R(M)$	Automorphism group of the R-module M
$\operatorname{Ann}_R(M)$	Annihilator of the R-module M
$M_R \otimes_R {}_RN,\ M \otimes_R N$	Tensor product of a right R-module M and a left R-module N
K/F	Field extension of F by K
$[K : F]$	Degree of the field extension K/F
$F(\alpha),\ F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n)$	Fields generated over F by the indicated elements
$F[\alpha]$	Subring (equivalently, F-subalgebra) generated by F and α
$m_{\alpha,F}(x)$	Minimal polynomial of α over F
$\overline{F}$	Algebraic closure of F
$\operatorname{Gal}(L/K)$	Galois group of L/K
L^H	Fixed field of $H \leq \operatorname{Gal}(L/K)$
$\operatorname{Tr}_{L/K}(\alpha)$	Field trace of $\alpha \in L$ from L to K
$\operatorname{N}_{L/K}(\alpha)$	Field norm of $\alpha \in L$ from L to K
$\operatorname{trdeg}_K L$	Transcendence degree of L over K

13 Topology

Notation	Meaning
$(X, \mathcal{T})$	Topological space X with topology $\mathcal{T}$
$\mathcal{T}$	Topology on the underlying set X
$\mathcal{B}$	Basis for a topology
$\mathcal{S}$	Subbasis for a topology
$A^\circ,\ \operatorname{int} A$	Interior of A
$\overline{A},\ \operatorname{cl} A$	Closure of A
∂A	Boundary of A
$\operatorname{ext} A$	Exterior of A in X
A'	Derived set of A (its accumulation points)
(X, d)	Metric space X with metric d
$\mathcal{T}_A = \{A \cap U \mid U \in \mathcal{T}\}$	Subspace topology on $A \subseteq X$
$\pi_i \colon \prod_{j \in J} X_j \to X_i$	Coordinate projection of a product space, for $i \in J$
$X/\!\sim$	Quotient space when the quotient set is equipped with the quotient topology

Notation	Meaning
$q\colon X \twoheadrightarrow X/\sim$	Canonical quotient map
X/A	Quotient space obtained by collapsing the subspace $A \subseteq X$ to a point
$C(X,Y)$	Set of continuous maps from X to Y
$X \cong Y$	Homeomorphic spaces
$\mathrm{Homeo}(X)$	Group of self-homeomorphisms of X
$\iota\colon A \hookrightarrow X$	Inclusion map of a subspace $A \subseteq X$
$f\colon X \hookrightarrow Y$	Topological embedding when explicitly stated; the hook arrow by itself retains its general meaning of injectivity
(X, x_0)	Pointed space with basepoint x_0
$I = [0,1]$	Unit interval, especially for paths and homotopies
$\gamma\colon I \to X$	Path in X
$\gamma(0) = \gamma(1) = x_0$	Loop based at x_0
$H\colon X \times I \to Y$	Homotopy between maps $X \to Y$
$f \simeq g$	Homotopic maps $f, g\colon X \to Y$
$X \simeq Y$	Homotopy equivalent spaces
$[\gamma]$	Homotopy class of a path or loop γ, according to context
$\pi_0(X)$	Set of path-connected components of X; not generally a group
$\pi_1(X, x_0)$	Fundamental group of X based at x_0
$\pi_n(X, x_0)$	nth homotopy group of the pointed space (X, x_0), for $n \geq 1$
f_*	Induced covariant map associated with f
f^*	Induced contravariant map associated with f
$p\colon \widetilde{X} \to X$	Covering map, with $\widetilde{X}$ a covering space of X
$\widetilde{X}$	Covering space of X; universal cover when specified
$\mathrm{Deck}(p)$	Group of deck transformations of the covering p
$D^n = \{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid \|\mathbf{x}\| \leq 1\}$	Closed n-disk
$X \vee Y$	Wedge sum of pointed spaces X and Y
T_0, T_1, T_2, T_3, T_4	Separation axioms, with T_3 including regularity and T_1, and T_4 including normality and T_1
M^n	n-dimensional topological manifold
∂M	Boundary of a manifold M
Σ_g	Closed connected orientable surface of genus g
$M \# N$	Connected sum of manifolds M and N
$\chi(X)$	Euler characteristic of X
$H_n(X; G)$	nth homology group of X with coefficients in G
$H_n(X, A; G)$	nth relative homology group of a pair (X, A) with coefficients in an abelian group G, where $A \subseteq X$
$H_n(X)$	Integral homology group $H_n(X; \mathbb{Z})$ when coefficients are omitted
$\widetilde{H}_n(X; G)$	nth reduced homology group of X with coefficients in G
$H^n(X; G)$	nth cohomology group of X with coefficients in G
$b_n(X)$	nth Betti number of X

14 Miscellaneous Notation

Notation	Meaning
$\lfloor x \rfloor$	Floor of x
$\lceil x \rceil$	Ceiling of x
$\{x\}$	Fractional part $x - \lfloor x \rfloor$, when unambiguous
$\operatorname{sgn}(x)$	Sign of a real number or permutation, according to context
$a \propto b$	a is proportional to b; in a functional context, the proportionality factor is independent of the variable under discussion.
$O(g(n))$	Big-O upper asymptotic bound
$o(g(n))$	Little-o strict asymptotic bound
$\Theta(g(n))$	Two-sided asymptotic order
$\Omega(g(n))$	Asymptotic lower bound
$f \lesssim g,\ f \gtrsim g$	Upper and lower bounds up to a positive constant factor, respectively
$f(x) \asymp g(x)$	Two-sided asymptotic bounds up to positive constant factors
$\sum_{\text{cyc}} f(a,b,c)$	Cyclic sum over a, b, c
$\sum_{\text{sym}} f(a,b,c)$	Symmetric sum over distinct permutations of a, b, c
Δq	Finite change in a quantity q
δ_{ij}	Kronecker delta: 1 if $i = j$ and 0 otherwise
ϵ_{ijk}	Three-dimensional Levi–Civita symbol: the sign of the permutation (i, j, k) when (i, j, k) is a permutation of $(1, 2, 3)$, and 0 otherwise